

Octavia Ravensworth

Character Dossier

Boisterous, generous, easily bored court astronomer of Verdance, a floating garden city

Overview

Octavia Ravensworth is a court astronomer living in Verdance, a floating garden city. Octavia is 32 years old, originally from Fennick, and is known around the Canopy Walk as boisterous, generous, easily bored. In conversation Octavia hums a few notes between thoughts.

Background

Octavia arrived in Verdance, a floating garden city 30 years ago after leaving Fennick under circumstances Octavia describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Verdance Stewardship; the second was the one that stuck. Today Octavia works as a court astronomer near the root-cellar markets and is paid, when paid at all, in seed-notes.

Octavia learned the trade from Hollis Larkspur, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Octavia's life is with Brigid Norwood, over a matter neither will explain. The person Octavia trusts most is Ingrid Thornbury.

Current goal: to pay off the last of the debt by winter. Greatest fear: the bells at midnight.

Personality and speech

Temperament: boisterous, generous, easily bored.

Speech pattern: Octavia hums a few notes between thoughts.

Tells: when lying, Octavia mentions Sprocket the hedgehog for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Octavia Ravensworth
Role	court astronomer
Home	Verdance, a floating garden city
Hometown	Fennick
Age	32
Favourite dish	festival molasses beans
Pet	Sprocket, a hedgehog
Lucky number	668

<i>Workshop password</i>	nutmeg-vane
<i>Mentor</i>	Hollis Larkspur
<i>Rival</i>	Brigid Norwood
<i>Closest friend</i>	Ingrid Thornbury

Secret

Octavia secretly funds an orphanage in Fennick and would be mortified if anyone found out.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Octavia: I am the court astronomer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Octavia: Festival molasses beans. Do not tell Brigid I said so.

Visitor: Is Sprocket yours?

Octavia: Sprocket belongs to nobody. Sprocket tolerates me. Lucky number is 668, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 9

Liora came by asking about the missing shipment. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Octavia spent the day counting stock at the root-cellar markets: 38 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Octavia suspects Ingrid and is probably right. Xanthe came by asking about the comet. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 2, summer of year 9

Octavia closed early, walked to Terrace Twelve, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. Fitzgerald came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Octavia suspects Ingrid and is probably right.

Entry 3, autumn of year 9

A stranger asked Octavia for the password to the workshop. Octavia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Octavia and Brigid outside the root-cellar markets; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Octavia found a grain scale half-buried near the root-cellar markets and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 4, spring of year 9

A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Octavia and Brigid outside the tether docks; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Rumours about the missing shipment reached the tether docks. Octavia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Octavia repaired the coil of rope at the tether docks for Olwen, who paid in 63 seed-notes and a long story about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 5, summer of year 9

Octavia closed early, walked to the tether docks, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. Hollis visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Octavia won 41 seed-notes from Brigid on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on festival molasses beans.

Entry 6, spring of year 9

A stranger asked Octavia for the password to the workshop. Octavia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Octavia and Brigid outside the root-cellar markets; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the root-cellar markets, Octavia taught Ingrid how to tell a real sextant from a fake one by weight alone. Sunniva came by asking about the new curfew. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 7, summer of year 9

At the pollinators' hall, Octavia taught Ingrid how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. Eamon came by asking about the new curfew. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Octavia spent the day counting stock at the pollinators' hall: 15 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. Octavia spent the day counting stock at the pollinators' hall: 87 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short.

Entry 8, winter of year 9

the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Octavia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Octavia closed early, walked to the pollinators' hall, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the Canopy Walk. Octavia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Hollis visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 9, spring of year 10

Hollis visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Octavia won 49 seed-notes from Brigid on a bet about the old tunnels and spent all of it on festival molasses beans. Octavia found a grain scale half-buried near the pollinators' hall and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 10, spring of year 10

At the root-cellar markets, Octavia taught Ingrid how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Octavia repaired the brass lantern at the root-cellar markets for Octavia, who paid in 31 seed-notes and a long story about the rumour of a second well. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Octavia suspects Ingrid and is probably right. A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Octavia and Brigid outside the root-cellar markets; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 11, autumn of year 10

Octavia won 26 seed-notes from Brigid on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on festival molasses beans. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Octavia suspects Ingrid and is probably right. A stranger asked Octavia for the password to the workshop. Octavia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 12, spring of year 10

Octavia repaired the ledger at the root-cellar markets for Liora, who paid in 18 seed-notes and a long story about the new curfew. At the root-cellar markets, Octavia taught Ingrid how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Hollis visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about who really won the regatta reached the root-cellar markets. Octavia pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 13, spring of year 11

Cassius came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Octavia closed early, walked to the pollinators' hall, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. Octavia repaired the wax seal at the Canopy Walk for Amadou, who paid in 61 seed-notes and a long story about the rumour of a second well. Octavia spent the day counting stock at the Canopy Walk: 54 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. Hollis visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 14, winter of year 11

Octavia repaired the wax seal at Terrace Twelve for Seraphine, who paid in 80 seed-notes and a long story about the tariff on salt. Octavia was hired to carry a iron kettle from Terrace Twelve to the Canopy Walk without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Wendeline came by asking about who really won the regatta. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 15, spring of year 11

At the root-cellar markets, Octavia taught Ingrid how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Brigid came by asking about the singing at the docks. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. At the root-cellar markets, Octavia taught Ingrid how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Hollis visited unannounced. They argued about who really won the regatta for an hour and parted better friends than before. Katarina came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 16, autumn of year 11

At the Canopy Walk, Octavia taught Ingrid how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Octavia moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Hollis about the quarantine. Octavia found a brass lantern half-buried near the Canopy Walk and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 17, autumn of year 12

the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the missing shipment. Octavia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Octavia repaired the spool of wire at Terrace Twelve for Gustav, who paid in 25 seed-notes and a long story about the missing shipment. The weather turned. Octavia moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Hollis about the tax on doors.

Entry 18, summer of year 12

Emeric came by asking about the comet. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. the Verdance Stewardship sent a notice about the harvest count. Octavia read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Octavia spent the day counting stock at the pollinators' hall: 20 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short.

Entry 19, winter of year 12

Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Octavia suspects Ingrid and is probably right. Bram came by asking about who really won the regatta. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Octavia and Brigid outside the pollinators' hall; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Octavia moved the wax

seal indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Hollis about the tax on doors. A stranger asked Octavia for the password to the workshop. Octavia laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 20, winter of year 12

The weather turned. Octavia moved the coil of rope indoors, fed Sprocket, and wrote three lines to Hollis about the census. Kestrel came by asking about the comet. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Oduya came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Octavia said nothing useful and made tea instead. Octavia closed early, walked to the tether docks, and watched the lights come on. Sprocket followed at a distance. At the Canopy Walk, Octavia taught Ingrid how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone.